Hackfest Hackathon 2026
Bengaluru Region - Finale Round

SAP

4th November 2026



Participant Handbook

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Why Hackfest

In a world where code is becoming commodity, it is no longer a competitive edge for students. At SAP, we always see problems from Domain, Tech and Business perspectives. Hackfest is an attempt to invigorate the student community, with these principles to solve real world burning problems, using this framework. We have been doing Hackfest for Engineering students, but with coding becoming a commodity, we see a larger diaspora of students having the ability to participate on level playing fields



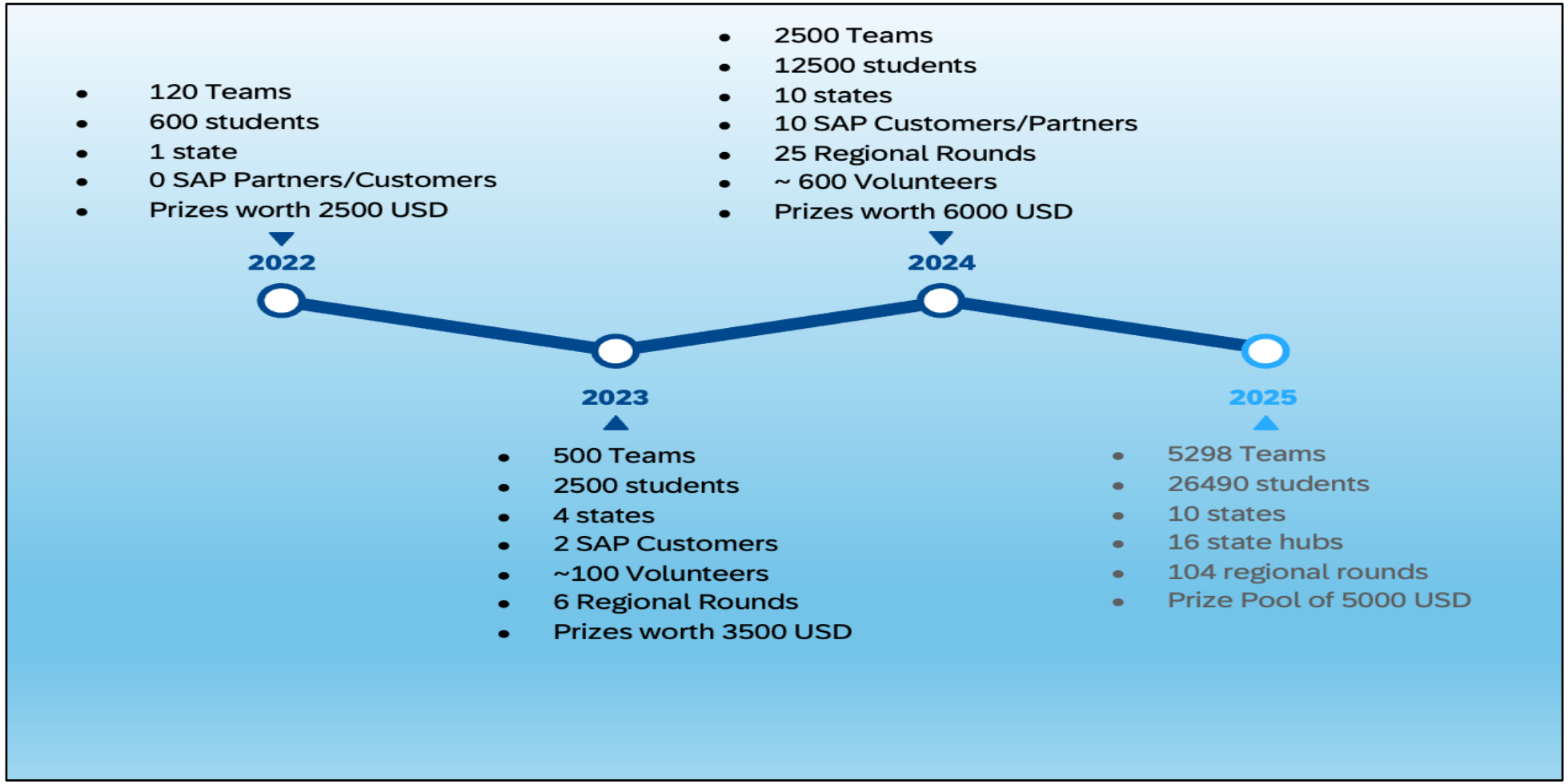
Hackfest 2023



Hackfest 2024

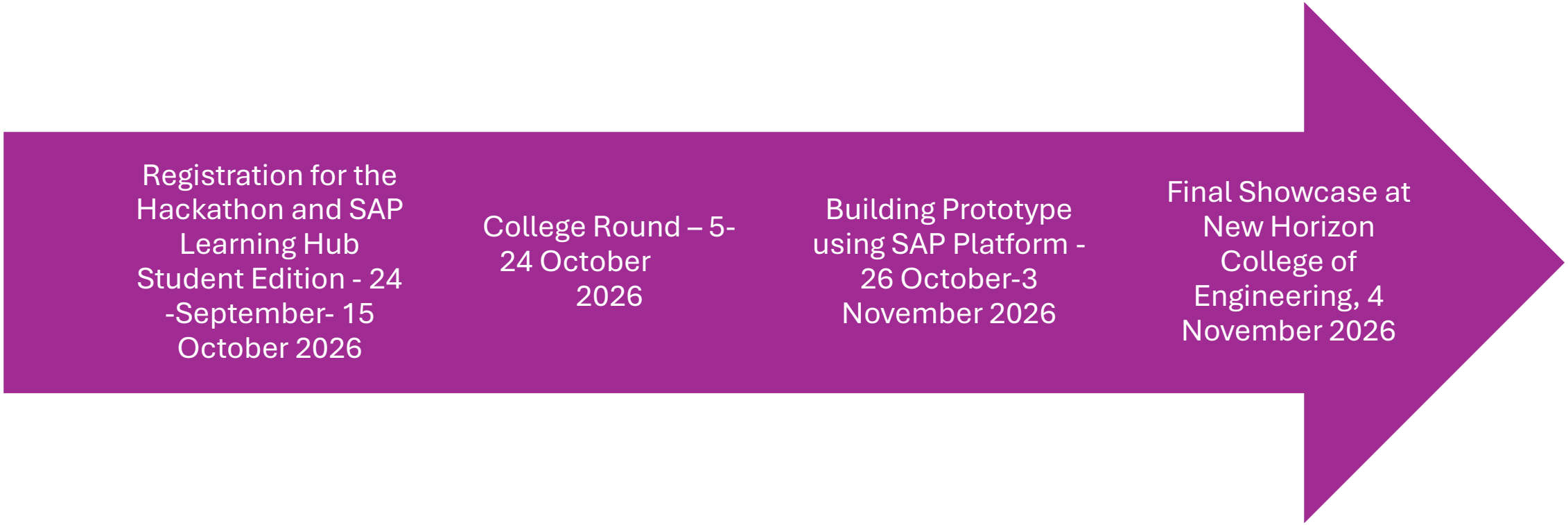
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The Hackfest Journey So Far



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Timelines



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Theme 1: Resilient Supply Chains

- When global supply chains break, the human cost is massive. Delays disrupt life-saving medicine, raise food prices for vulnerable populations, and wipe out incomes for small-scale farmers.
- This supply chain has now shifted from cost-optimized to resilience-first. Driven by maritime re-routings, dynamic tariff policies, geopolitical shifts, and climate shocks, structural disruption is now a constant reality. Traditional planning tools can no longer keep pace.
- Supply chain resilience is a top priority for SAP's global customers. Using industry foundations like SAP IBP, Transportation Management, and Ariba, along with next-gen SAP Joule AI Agents, businesses are shifting toward autonomous, self-healing networks. This Hackfest gives you direct experience in the exact space where enterprise tech is evolving fastest.
- **This year's SAP Hackfest challenges you to harness Agentic AI to build supply chains that don't just react, but autonomously sense, adapt, and recover in real time.**
- Your solution will leverage a team of specialized AI agents:

- Sensing & Scenario Agents
- Logistics & Inventory Agents
- Compliance & Human-in-the-Loop Safeguards

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Theme 2: Inclusive Workforce

- AI is reshaping global employment, turning traditional hiring upside down and creating a $5.5T global skills gap. The challenge is no longer *"Will AI take jobs?"* It's *"Who will AI leave behind?"*
- Human Capital Management is at the core of SAP's strategic focus. Through SAP SuccessFactors, the Talent Intelligence Hub, and next-gen Joule AI Agents, SAP is leading the shift toward skills-first hiring, automated talent development, and smart recruiting. This theme isn't abstract. It's about your future workforce.
- **Your challenge is to build AI solutions that include, empower, and upskill. Hackfest teams will design a multi-agent AI ecosystem where below-mentioned specialized agents collaborate to create a fair, skill-first workforce platform:**

- Skills Discovery Agent
- Market Intelligence Agent
- Learning Pathway Agent
- Inclusive Matching Agent
- Employer Readiness & Bias Audit Agents
- Human-in-the-Loop

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From Idea to Prototype: The Two-Round Process

Theme 1: Resilient Supply Chains

Round 1 (Regional College Round): Design Thinking & Business Model *(No Code)*

The Challenge: Select a supply chain scenario (e.g., pharma cold chain, disaster relief logistics, or tariff-exposed networks).

The Deliverable: Perform empathy mapping, identify system failure modes, map agent-human interactions, and build a Business Model Canvas using the SAP Learning Hub, student edition

Round 2 (Grand Finale): Prototyping & Live Demo

Single Agent Prototype: Build a functional core agent (e.g., a *Disruption Sensing* or *Scenario Planning Agent*) using vibe coding and AI frameworks.

Full System Showcase: Demo an end-to-end multi-agent network simulating a live disruption (e.g., shipping closures or tariff spikes)—showing autonomous rerouting, audit logging, human approval, and SAP Learning Hub, student edition integration.

Theme 2: Inclusive Workforce

Round 1 (Regional College Round): Design Thinking & Business Model *(No Code)*

The Challenge: Select an inclusion challenge (e.g., reskilling displaced workers, matching persons with disabilities, or supporting women re-entering the workforce).

The Deliverable: Conduct empathy mapping, identify systemic hiring barriers, design agent-human interaction models, and build a sustainable Business Model Canvas using the SAP Learning Hub, student edition.

Round 2 (Grand Finale): Prototyping & Live Demo

Single Agent Prototype: Build a functional core agent (e.g., a *Skills Discovery* or *Learning Pathway Agent*) using vibe coding and AI frameworks.

Full System Showcase: Demo the complete multi-agent "Career Orchestrator" end-to-end via a real-world persona (e.g., a woman re-entering the workforce in a tier-2 city), demonstrating seamless agent collaboration, human-in-the-loop safeguards, and SAP Learning Hub, student edition integration.

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Participant Guideline

1. Teams to show all the artifacts and working prototype based on one of the chosen themes
2. Participants should primarily use the links shared with them of the SAP platform & system landscape. Can also use other non-SAP tools to build the prototype
3. Each Team will be given 15 mins in Total (10 Presentation, 5 mins Q & A)
4. Use the time allotted to the team judiciously, going overboard on time limits will be penalised
5. Keep the demo related artifacts in one laptop, do not waste time switching laptops during your presentation
6. Keep the video of the demo ready as backup, you can use the same if your demo doesn’t work
7. Keep the laptop charged and if there is a special connector required to connect to projector, please bring the same

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Evaluation Criteria

Problem Identification(Specifics & Validation)

Focus: Has the team found a meaningful problem and validated it with research?

Dimension : Specificity

Is the problem precisely scoped (context, boundaries) vs. a generic theme?

Dimension : Root Cause

Does the team understand why the problem exists (incentives, systems, history)?

Dimension : Stakeholder Validation

Valid evidence (interviews, data, reports) vs. pure assumptions?

Systems Thinking(Complexity & Context)

Focus: Does the solution fit into the messy reality of an enterprise environment?

Dimension : Process Links

Upstream/downstream dependencies mapped? (Not a siloed solution).

Dimension : 2nd Order Consequences

Unintended consequences or ripple effects considered?

Dimension : Change Management

Strategy for adoption, training, and overcoming resistance?

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Evaluation Criteria

Business Viability(Value & Market)

Focus: Is there a business case? Who pays and why?

Dimension : Value Proposition

Clear, specific ROI or outcome for the buyer?

Dimension : Revenue Model

Is there a realistic revenue model ?

Dimension : Go-to-Market

How to does the team intend to sell the solution?

Demo & Feasibility(Prototype)

Focus: Can this actually be built and deployed in a corporate environment?

Dimension : Prototype

Demo proves the core value proposition (function over flash)?

Dimension : Resources

Estimation of Timeline, Skills and Overall Cost

Dimension : Presentation & Team Work

How well did the team present ? Did the participants work as team ?

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Jury Members' Role

1. Jury members should not favour a certain team, individually help and evaluate the teams to get them to be the best they can be.
2. Evaluation criteria sheets and briefing will be given to all jury members as the final days approach.
3. <u>Jury members would need to note:</u>

- Problem statements are not going to be given, rather themes are given to teams, hence they must:

A. Arrive at the problem statement

B. Defend the market, feasibility and viability

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Additional Notes

1. Prize Money would be, 75k, 50k and 25k INR (For top 3 teams) in the Grand Finale Round on 4th November.
2. SAP would provide learning resources (SAP Learning Hub (Student's Edition)) to the teams and students must register and use them. Any team using the learning from there would definitely have an edge during the evaluations.
3. Teams do not need to follow a certain presentation template, they can be innovative about the same.
4. Just keep in mind that 15 mins of total time will be given - 10 min for teams to present and 5 min for Q&A.

5) Teams are expected to be in full attendance (all 4 or 5 team members) are to be present on the presentation days.

6) The Core Team (SAP + NHCE), will take all final decisions and calls on evaluation and other aspects logistic or otherwise for the teams and jury.

7) Selection of the Top 3 Teams would be decided by SAP based on the Evaluation score sheets from Faculties & Industry Partners

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Learning Assets

Hands-On Practice Systems

SAP BTP – Hands-on Practice for Develop extensions with CAP following the SAP BTP Developer's Guide
SAP Build - SAP Build , SAP Business Application Studio – Sandbox , Advanced SAP UI5 Development
SAP S/4HANA -SPS07 - SAP HANA Installing and Administering , Provisioning data to SAP HANA Cloud , SAP HANA Cloud - Modeling
SAP SAC - Exploring SAP Analytics Cloud , SAP Analytics Cloud: Modeling and Data Transformation , SAP Analytics Cloud: Story Design
SAP BDC – Applying AI-powered Visualizations and Augmented Analytics to Business Data in SAP Analytics Cloud
SAP GEN AI- Solve your business problems using prompts and LLMs in SAP Generative AI Hub

Trial Systems

SAP S/4HANA- Get Started with the SAP HANA Database Explorer | SAP Tutorials , Get Started with SAP HANA Cloud | SAP Tutorials
SAP BTP & Build - Create Your First App on Cloud Foundry | SAP Tutorials , Get Started with SAP Business Technology Platform SAP HANA Service | SAP Tutorials , Create an Application with SAP Build Apps | SAP Tutorials
SAP BDC - SAP Business Data Cloud trial

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Thank You

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